

Winnie the Pooh

Winnie the Pooh is a favourite character with children all over the world. He is a lovable but not very smart bear and the imaginary adventures of Winnie and his friends have delighted children for over 70 years. But the magic of Winnie started long before that.

The history of Winnie the Pooh began when a young Canadian soldier named Harry Coleburn, who was also a vet, was on his way to fight in World War I. When the train in which he was travelling stopped at White River Bend station, Harry saw a man carrying a young black bear cub. Harry discovered that the man was a hunter who had shot and killed the cub's mother. He bought the young cub and named her Winnipeg after his home town. Soon he shortened this to Winnie.



Harry took the young bear to London with him where it became the mascot for the soldiers of his brigade. In 1919 the brigade was sent to France. Harry knew he could not take Winnie with him so he donated her to London Zoo.

Winnie quickly became the zoo's most popular attraction. One young fan was a little boy named Christopher Robin Milne. Christopher liked Winnie so much that he renamed his teddy bear after her. He added 'the Pooh' from the name of a swan in one of his father's poems—so his teddy bear became known as 'Winnie the Pooh'.

Christopher's father, A.A. Milne, was a writer. He had written a book of poems for young children titled *When We Were Very Young*. In 1925 he wrote a bedtime story for his son. It featured a small boy named Christopher Robin, a teddy bear named Winnie the Pooh and a number of other toy animals, based on Christopher's own stuffed toys. The adventures of Winnie the Pooh, Tigger, Eeyore, Piglet and their friends were set in a magical place called the Hundred Acre Wood which was in fact Cotchford Farm, where the Milne family lived. In 1926 A.A. Milne included this story as the first chapter of the book *Winnie-the-Pooh*.

While the real bear that inspired the stories died in 1934, the adventures of Winnie the Pooh continue to delight children through stories and films.

1. Harry Coleburn was a soldier and
 - (A) a vet.
 - (B) a writer.
 - (C) a hunter.
 - (D) a farmer.

2. In what year was Winnie donated to London Zoo?
 - (A) 1919
 - (B) 1925
 - (C) 1926
 - (D) 1934

3. What was the origin of 'Pooh' in the name 'Winnie the Pooh'?
 - (A) It was made up to rhyme with 'zoo'.
 - (B) It was the pet name given to Christopher Robin.
 - (C) It was a name taken from a particular breed of bear.
 - (D) It was the name of a swan in one of A.A. Milne's poems.

4. In the text the letters 'A.A.' are
 - (A) an abbreviation of a poem's title.
 - (B) the first letters of a person's given names.
 - (C) a title given to authors of children's books.
 - (D) a special name Christopher had for his father.

5. The book *Winnie-the-Pooh* was developed from
 - (A) everyday events on Cotchford Farm.
 - (B) Winnie's experiences at London Zoo.
 - (C) a bedtime story for Christopher Robin.
 - (D) a poem in *When We Were Very Young*.

6. The idea for the characters of Eeyore and Tigger came from
 - (A) some animals at the zoo.
 - (B) some of Christopher Robin's toys.
 - (C) some of the animals that lived on the farm.
 - (D) some wild animals in the Hundred Acre Wood.



SUPER DOOPER JEZEBEL

Jezebel was perfect in every way. She was so perfect she was called Super Dooper Jezebel.

When other children came out of school, they were sometimes untidy. But Jezebel was always super dooper neat. Jezebel always kept her room tidy, and she always put her things back in their boxes.

When she went out to play with her friends, Jezebel always kept clean.

At school, she was best at everything. She could do up buttons, and tie real bows on her lace-ups. Jezebel always ate up her meals. She always put her knife and fork together, and she *never* picked her nose.

Jezebel told other children not to do things ... 'Sucking your thumb makes your teeth stick out. I never do that and I've got super teeth!'

When the Prime Minister heard about Jezebel, she sent her a special medal for being good, and a special statue of Jezebel was put up in the park, to remind everybody else to try to be perfect.

She even went on television, in a special show to talk about herself and her medal, and the cups she had won for being polite, being spotless, being helpful, being best at sums, reading, poetry and writing.

At school, Super Dooper Jezebel wouldn't do anything wrong ... like the other noisy children who weren't perfect ...

Come on Jezebel...
A crocodile has escaped
from the zoo!



You mustn't run,
it's against the rules!
I ALWAYS walk nicely!
If you run, your socks
will come down!



CLUMP!

You naughty boy,
you've eaten the best
girl in the world!



I've tasted
better!



7. Jezebel was called 'Super Dooper' because she
- (A) knew the Prime Minister.
 - (B) cared about other children's feelings.
 - (C) was liked by the other children.
 - (D) was very good at everything she did.
8. What would happen when Jezebel went out to play with her friends?
- Jezebel would
- (A) tell them to take a bath.
 - (B) practise her sums.
 - (C) never get dirty.
 - (D) do up their buttons for them.
9. Why did Jezebel appear on television?
- (A) to tell people about her achievements
 - (B) to introduce the audience to her statue
 - (C) to explain the importance of cleanliness
 - (D) to host a children's program on television
10. Which of these words from the passage are opposite in meaning?
- | | | |
|-----|--------|----------|
| (A) | clean | spotless |
| (B) | neat | untidy |
| (C) | polite | helpful |
| (D) | nice | perfect |
11. The words 'I've tasted better!' suggest that the crocodile
- (A) did not think Jezebel was perfect.
 - (B) was still hungry.
 - (C) did not like being away from the zoo.
 - (D) was angry with Jezebel.
12. What message is the cartoon giving the reader?
- (A) Never smile at a crocodile.
 - (B) Teachers always know best.
 - (C) You have to know when to break the rules.
 - (D) Walk, don't run, when you see a wild animal.
13. In the cartoon the word 'ALWAYS' is written in capital letters to
- (A) illustrate how frightened Jezebel is.
 - (B) stress the importance of walking nicely.
 - (C) indicate that it is inside a speech bubble.
 - (D) show that Jezebel is emphasising the word.



Brian and the Brain

Brian had homework. It was writing, and writing was a bit of a problem for Brian. Whatever he produced, it would look as if a drunken spider had staggered across the page. Whatever he produced, he knew what Miss Spenshaw would say.

'It may be the best work in the history of the school, Brian, but as I can't read it we shall never know, shall we? Perhaps we need to get it translated.'

There's nothing like a good joke, thought Brian, and **that's** nothing like a good joke.

Of course, there would be no problem if he could do it on the computer. But last week, while he'd been trying to install *Attack of the Killer Klingfilms*, Mum's story *Ellie and the Elves Go Skipping* had somehow got deleted. She'd been about to send it off to her publisher. Brian felt it was unfair. Mum had claimed that it

was his fault. But the whole family knew what the computer was like. An eccentric, cranky old thing. Second-hand from the eccentric, cranky old woman down the road, 'The Brain' had come into the family like an intelligent but unreliable dog. You never knew if it was going to lick, bite or wee on the carpet. You touched it at your peril. Dad wouldn't go near it. Not since the mouse had given him an electric shock.

The Brain had no sense of humour. In the face of the most ridiculous spelling mistake it would merely add a solemn red line underneath. It ignored Brian's expertise at space games—even when he got top of the top ten. And sometimes it would announce unexpectedly that you had performed an illegal operation and the program would now be closed down or else. Brian often wondered what it would do—send the computer police around? He thought about what they would look like. Would they knock politely or beat the door down?

14. Which picture shows what is described in the line 'Whatever he produced, it would look as if a drunken spider had staggered across the page'?

(A) During the rescue
winging about I
I climbed on
he tried to gra
ied again and

(B) During the rescue
winging about I k
girl. I climbed on
he tried to gra
tried again and

(C) During the rescue
winging about I
I climbed on
he tried to gra
ied again and

(D) During the rescue
winging about
I climbed on
she tried to g
he tried again

15. The sentence 'There's nothing like a good joke, thought Brian, and **that's** nothing like a good joke.' means that

- (A) Miss Spenshaw thought her joke was better.
- (B) Brian thought Miss Spenshaw's joke was not funny.
- (C) Brian thought Miss Spenshaw should tell more jokes.
- (D) Miss Spenshaw thought Brian's writing was not amusing.

16. Why are the words '*Attack of the Killer Klingfilms*' and '*Ellie and the Elves Go Skipping*' written in italics?

- (A) to indicate that they are titles
- (B) to show that they are important
- (C) to advertise the computer game and the story
- (D) to explain that they had been deleted from the computer

17. According to the text, Brian's mother most probably works as

- (A) a writer.
- (B) a teacher.
- (C) a shop assistant.
- (D) a computer programmer.

18. Which of the following describes Brain the computer?

- (A) It is the dog's favourite toy.
- (B) It spies on the family's activities.
- (C) It cannot be used for computer games.
- (D) It cannot be trusted to work when it is needed.

19. The boy Brian could be described as

- (A) being a tidy worker.
- (B) having many friends.
- (C) having a sense of humour.
- (D) being a competitive student.

For questions 20 to 23 choose the correct option to complete the passage.

Maggie

Many people give up some of their free time to help others. They are called volunteers. Maggie goes to a zoo _____ (20) _____ Saturday where she is a volunteer. She has to get up very early and drive to the zoo. During the winter it is still dark and cold when she arrives _____ (21) _____ her destination. Her favourite animals are the pandas _____ (22) _____ were gifts from the Chinese government. She is always delighted _____ (23) _____ she is rostered to help their keeper.

20. (A) one
(B) last
(C) every
(D) either

21. (A) at
(B) in
(C) to
(D) for

22. (A) they
(B) what
(C) those
(D) which

23. (A) when
(B) unless
(C) so that
(D) and then



For questions 24 to 26 choose the best option.

24. Hal is not a very helpful person. He never thinks of other people and refuses to share his things with anyone.

The best word to describe Hal is

- (A) selfish.
- (B) forgetful.
- (C) foolish.
- (D) careless.

25. Lin woke up and smiled to herself. She remembered that today was the first day of the school holidays.

How did Lin feel when she woke up?

- (A) jealous
- (B) nervous
- (C) cheerful
- (D) lazy

26. Allowing two young children to make biscuits was not a good idea. In the process they had turned themselves into batter-covered piglets, and had made the kitchen their sty.

Which word describes the state of the kitchen?

- (A) greasy
- (B) unfinished
- (C) dangerous
- (D) disorganised



Making a worm farm

A worm farm is a useful way of turning food scraps into compost for your garden.

You can buy a worm farm, build one with boxes or make a worm bed in your garden.

The worm box should be about 30 cm deep, 60 cm wide and 90 cm long. The box must have holes in the base to allow air in and for good drainage. The box should have a lid or be covered with hessian or jute cloth. It also needs a base or tray underneath to catch liquid.

Place a combination of compost, leaves and paper inside the box as bedding for the worms. The bedding should be torn or shredded so that the worms can move around easily and the bedding material should be soaked in water before it is added to the box. Make the bedding layer 10–15 cm deep.

Now add the worms: between one and two thousand worms is a good number to start with. Spread the worms out gently on the surface and allow them to burrow down.

HINT: Worms can be bought from commercial worm growers or through your local nursery. They are generally sold by the thousand (1000 worms weigh about 250 grams).

HINT: Worms find smaller scraps easier and quicker to digest. Blend food scraps with water before feeding worms.



Start adding your kitchen waste regularly in small amounts. Simply place the food waste in the box and cover it with bedding material or a handful of soil or compost.

Don't add too much at once. Give the worms more food only when they have eaten most of their previous meal.

HINT: The liquid produced by your worm farm is full of nutrients—dilute and use on your pot plants.

27. You can improve the drainage of your worm farm by
- (A) watering the bed more often.
 - (B) increasing the depth of the bedding.
 - (C) adding more holes in the base of the box.
 - (D) placing some hessian over the lid of the box.
28. What is the correct sequence of steps for making a worm farm?
- 1. Shred paper and leaves.
 - 2. Add food waste into the box.
 - 3. Make holes in the box.
 - 4. Soak the bedding in water.
- (A) 1, 4, 3, 2
 - (B) 3, 1, 4, 2
 - (C) 3, 2, 1, 4
 - (D) 2, 1, 4, 3
29. How many worms should you use to begin your worm farm?
- (A) at least 1000 worms
 - (B) no more than 250 worms
 - (C) approximately 1000 grams of worms
 - (D) enough worms to fill to a depth of 15 cm
30. 'Commercial' worm growers are people who grow worms
- (A) at home.
 - (B) as a hobby.
 - (C) for research.
 - (D) as a business.
31. In the last paragraph the sentence 'Don't add too much at once' is
- (A) a definition.
 - (B) a statement.
 - (C) an instruction.
 - (D) an exclamation.
32. Why is the liquid from the worm farm useful?
- (A) It is nutritious for your worms.
 - (B) It can be used to fertilise plants.
 - (C) It increases the rate at which the worms multiply.
 - (D) It reduces the amount of compost needed in the box.
33. The hints have been placed separately from the main text because
- (A) they provide additional information.
 - (B) the writer is not sure if the information is correct.
 - (C) the information is necessary to keep worms healthy.
 - (D) there is not enough detail to include them in the passage.



Clean and Dine

Feeling a little dirty? Parasites giving you trouble? Just drop by the local cleaning station and all your dead, decaying cells, mucus and parasites will be nibbled away. This cleaning service is not only beneficial for you, it also provides a meal for your cleaner. It is your own very personal symbiotic cleaning service.

Cleaning symbiosis describes a relationship between two animals. In this relationship, the parasites, dead and decaying skin cells and other harmful and unwanted materials that live on one animal are removed by another animal. The materials which are removed provide a meal for the animal that does the cleaning. Such symbiotic relationships are important in marine environments, for example, where some fish rely on cleaning other fish for their own nutrition.

There are more than 100 species of fish that spend all or part of their lives eating the body waste of other fish and marine animals. The most common cleaner fish are butterfly fish, wrasses and surperches. Their clients not only include other fish, but also sharks, turtles, crustaceans, sea urchins and starfish.

Cleaner fish often work at 'cleaning stations' among coral reefs. These stations are like 'drive-thru' services, where clients swim up and a cleaner fish

takes their order. Client fish take motionless, open-finned poses to signal they need cleaning. They will turn upside down or on their side and even hold their gill covers open so the cleaners can get inside and nibble at their filaments. Some fish even change colour when they want a good grooming. Scientists are not certain why they do this, but it may help the cleaners see the parasites.

Cleaner fish are extremely thorough. They clean inside the mouth, gills, around the fins and in all the other little nooks and crannies which are perfect spots to gobble up accumulated mucus, dead cells and nasty parasites.

The blue-stripe cleaner wrasse can eat up to 1200 parasites a day at a rate of 4.8 per minute. This type of efficiency is important because too many parasites can be deadly and as research shows that parasites return within one to six days, regular cleaning is important.

While many cleaners rely on parasites and body waste for nutrition, there is also another benefit—self-preservation. By providing an essential service for larger fish and animals that would normally eat them, cleaner fish avoid becoming prey. After all, do not bite the hand that cleans you!



34. What is the main purpose of the paragraph which is written in *italics*?
- (A) to argue the benefits of personal hygiene
 - (B) to ask the reader to imagine they are cleaning a fish
 - (C) to advise people who want to learn how to clean a fish
 - (D) to provide a context which explains a symbiotic relationship
35. How do client fish indicate when they are ready to be cleaned?
- (A) They remain still and open their fins.
 - (B) They stretch their mouths wide open.
 - (C) They swim up to the 'cleaning stations'.
 - (D) They roll around and open their gill covers.
36. Which group of words from paragraph five provides evidence that cleaner fish are 'extremely thorough'?
- (A) 'clean inside'
 - (B) 'nooks and crannies'
 - (C) 'perfect spots'
 - (D) 'accumulated mucus'
37. Why is regular cleaning for client fish important?
- (A) Parasites affect the colour of client fish.
 - (B) Cleaner fish can only remove 1200 parasites a day.
 - (C) Parasites return to live on client fish very soon after cleaning.
 - (D) Cleaner fish do not remove all the parasites found on client fish.
38. Synonyms are words which have the same meaning.
Which of the following pairs of words are synonyms in the text?
- (A) 'decaying' and 'deadly'
 - (B) 'common' and 'regular'
 - (C) 'nibble' and 'gobble'
 - (D) 'important' and 'essential'
39. Why has the cartoon been included with the text?
- (A) to provide an alternative point of view
 - (B) to include an additional piece of information
 - (C) to summarise the information in a humorous way
 - (D) to illustrate the order in which the cleaning is done

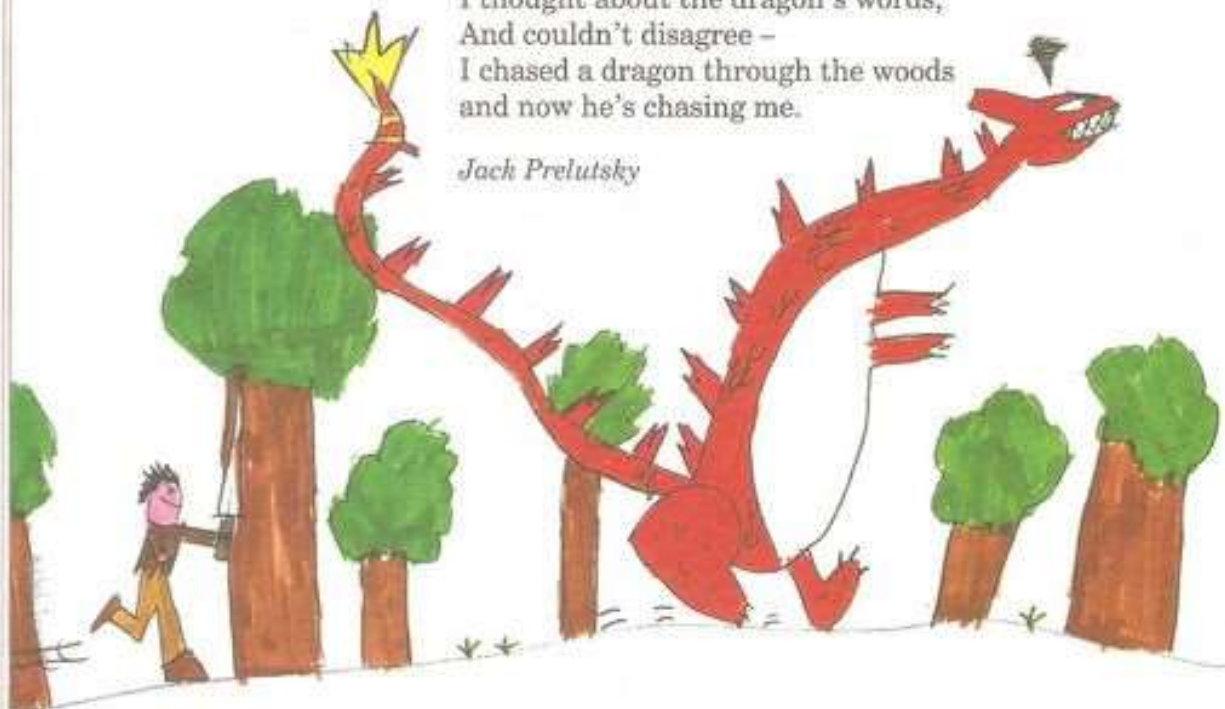
I CHASED A DRAGON THROUGH THE WOODS

I chased a dragon through the woods,
Haranguing him all day.
'I'll catch you soon!' I taunted,
'You can never get away.
There's no escaping me, my friend,'
I confidently cried.
'You might as well stop running,
there is nowhere you can hide.
I think that I will simply lop
your head off with my sword.'
The dragon stopped and whirled about
And ominously roared.

'You'd better think again,' he boomed,
and glared into my eyes.
'In case you hadn't noticed,
I'm a dozen times your size.
It's evident that I'd prevail
If ever we should fight.
I'm quite accomplished with my claws
and furthermore, I bite!'

I thought about the dragon's words,
And couldn't disagree –
I chased a dragon through the woods
and now he's chasing me.

Jack Prelutsky



40. What is the main idea in the first stanza of the poem?
- (A) The dragon is worried that the boy will escape.
 - (B) The boy is frightened by the dragon's loud roar.
 - (C) The dragon is enjoying a game of hide and seek with the boy.
 - (D) The boy is certain that he will succeed in catching the dragon.
41. The dragon thinks that he will beat the boy in a fight because
- (A) he has a sword that he can use.
 - (B) he is more intelligent than the boy.
 - (C) he has a size advantage over the boy.
 - (D) he can disguise himself in the woods.
42. Which word from the poem tells us that the dragon thought he was a good fighter?
- (A) 'noticed'
 - (B) 'accomplished'
 - (C) 'furthermore'
 - (D) 'bite'
43. What is happening at the end of the poem?
- (A) The boy is teasing the dragon.
 - (B) The dragon is fighting the boy.
 - (C) The dragon is hiding from the boy.
 - (D) The boy is running from the dragon.
44. Which two words from the poem rhyme?
- (A) 'friend' and 'cried'
 - (B) 'sword' and 'roared'
 - (C) 'size' and 'fight'
 - (D) 'words' and 'woods'
45. Which of the following words from the poem is used as a verb?
- (A) 'through'
 - (B) 'lop'
 - (C) 'quite'
 - (D) 'claws'

